

Signature:

I hereby confirm that all the pages of my exam paper
have been stapled to this cover sheet.

End-of-Module Exam: 2026 Spring Semester

Zürcher Hochschule

für Angewandte Wissenschaften

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Number of supplementary answer sheets attached:

Total number of added pages:

Module:	w.BA.XX08-WIN.XX / Data Science Introduction
Exam date / time:	26.08.2026 / 15:30 – 16:30
Duration:	60 Minutes
Total number of pages:	2
Permissible resources:	Closed book
Calculator:	no calculator
Dictionary:	Yes

General information:

- Use a black or blue pen (invisible ink is not allowed) to write your answers.
- All options of a question (i.e. A–D) can be ticked.
- ONLY tick ONE option per question in the table.
- Scoring: each correctly answered question = 1 point.
- Write your answers only on the answer sheet provided; rough work on question pages is not scored.
- Switch off your mobile phone and put it in your bag for the duration of the examination.
- If you want to write a draft, use the back of the question pages. Only the answer sheet counts.
- Please remain seated until all exams have been collected.

Marked by:	Total points:	Grade:

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Grading Table

Performance Assessment	Weighting	Grade	Weighted Grade
Performance Assessment 1	100%		
		<i>(Grade on cover sheet)</i>	
Module grade (Evento)			⇐ Rounded ⇐

Marking Table

No.	Task	Points	Corrector's, initials
1	MC written Exam	30 Points	hitz
	Total	30 Points	

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Answer sheet

ONLY the answer sheet will be scored. All options of a question (i.e. A–D) can be ticked.

ONLY tick ONE option per question in this table.

Scoring: Each correctly answered question is worth **1 point**.

Example: For question 0, C should be ticked, then it would look like this.

Question	Answer	Question	Answer
1.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	16.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
2.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	17.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
3.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	18.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
4.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	19.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
5.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	20.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
6.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	21.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
7.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	22.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
8.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	23.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
9.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	24.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
10.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	25.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
11.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	26.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
12.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	27.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
13.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	28.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
14.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	29.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
15.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	30.	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D

MC Data Science Introduction (30 Points)

1. A consultant wants to simulate how inventory levels and ordering delays cause oscillations over time. Which approach fits best? (1)
 - A. The Viable System Model.
 - B. The SMOTE algorithm.
 - C. System Dynamics.
 - D. A confusion matrix.
2. Which single statement about Ashby-style adaptation is correct? (1)
 - A. Adaptation means permanently freezing the system's variety.
 - B. A system adapts by matching the environment's variety, e.g. through amplification or attenuation.
 - C. Adaptation requires ignoring the environment.
 - D. If environmental variety exceeds capacity, the system automatically thrives.
3. Which statement is NOT correct regarding the Data Science distinction? (1)
 - A. Analytics is one component within Data Science.
 - B. Big Data and Data Science mean exactly the same thing.
 - C. Big Data refers primarily to data traits and infrastructure.
 - D. Data Science is a broad, transdisciplinary discipline.
4. Which statement about real-time adaptive modeling is NOT correct? (1)
 - A. Concept drift is irrelevant to adaptive models.
 - B. Model-based reinforcement learning builds an environment model to plan ahead.
 - C. CPS event streams provide fast, continuous feedback.
 - D. Stream/online learning updates the model as new data arrives.
5. A model scores 98% on the training set but only 70% on the test set. This most likely indicates... (1)
 - A. underfitting.
 - B. high bias.
 - C. overfitting / high variance.
 - D. perfect generalization.

6. In human-centric systems, the main legitimate purpose of a dashboard is to... (1)
- A. combat data overload and make internal processes visible.
 - B. manipulate stakeholders into a decision.
 - C. replace all analysis.
 - D. hide data from users.
7. Which single statement about complexity is correct? (1)
- A. CPS data is always IID and perfectly structured.
 - B. Complexity is merely complicatedness with many individual parts.
 - C. Complexity involves many interdependent variables whose cause and effect are non-obvious.
 - D. You can always gain full overview of and control over a complex system.
8. Which statement about class weighting is NOT correct? (1)
- A. It helps prevent the majority class from dominating.
 - B. It is useful for imbalanced problems such as fraud detection.
 - C. It modifies the training loss.
 - D. It physically duplicates or deletes data rows.
9. Which statement about target-oriented action is NOT correct? (1)
- A. The closed loop culminates in a concrete action (sense-think-act).
 - B. Start with a measurable goal.
 - C. Align stakeholders on the same target.
 - D. It is best to start data-first and let goals emerge later.
10. Explainable AI (XAI) primarily aims to... (1)
- A. hide the model's internal logic.
 - B. explain why a model made a decision, supporting user trust.
 - C. maximize predictive accuracy only.
 - D. remove human oversight.
11. Which cyber-layer functions typically support CPS control? (1)
- A. Complex Event Processing (CEP) and Statistical Process Control (SPC).
 - B. Only manual rules written by operators.
 - C. Only static spreadsheets.
 - D. None - control needs no data.
12. Which single statement about Stafford Beer's VSM is correct? (1)
- A. It excludes feedback by design.
 - B. It is a recursive, cybernetics-based structure whose subsystems monitor and regulate one another.
 - C. It is identical to a static organisational chart.
 - D. It is a linear plan with no recursion.

13. Which statement about class imbalance is NOT correct? (1)
- A. Resampling and class weighting can help.
 - B. SMOTE interpolates new minority samples.
 - C. High accuracy always means the minority class is well predicted.
 - D. The minority class is often the important one.
14. Which statement about uncertainty is NOT correct? (1)
- A. Scenario thinking helps under uncertainty.
 - B. Data may exist, yet outcomes remain unpredictable.
 - C. Uncertainty differs from complexity and volatility.
 - D. Uncertainty means a total absence of data.
15. Unsupervised learning... (1)
- A. finds hidden structure or groupings in unlabeled data.
 - B. requires labeled data.
 - C. predicts known labels for new data.
 - D. always learns from rewards and penalties.
16. 'Fatal undercomplexity' refers to... (1)
- A. having too much controller variety.
 - B. an irrelevant theoretical concept.
 - C. control mechanisms that are insufficient for the situation's complexity.
 - D. a perfectly matched controller and system.
17. Which single statement about System Dynamics is correct? (1)
- A. Stocks are rates of change and flows are accumulations.
 - B. Balancing loops counteract change while reinforcing loops amplify it.
 - C. Reinforcing loops always stabilise a system.
 - D. It assumes strictly linear cause and effect.
18. Which statement about the smart factory is NOT correct? (1)
- A. It is a purely offline reporting system.
 - B. MES bridge machines and ERP systems.
 - C. It integrates physical and cyber layers.
 - D. Predictive maintenance reduces unplanned downtime.
19. Which statement about model performance evaluation is NOT correct? (1)
- A. Accuracy can be misleading under class imbalance.
 - B. High training accuracy removes the need for evaluation.
 - C. In CRISP-DM, evaluation aligns with a predefined design and expert feedback.
 - D. Precision is correct-among-predicted-positives; recall is found-among-actual-positives.

20. Which of the following is an unsupervised clustering algorithm? (1)
- A. Linear regression
 - B. A decision-tree classifier
 - C. K-means
 - D. Logistic regression
21. A 'Customer 360' view unifying data across systems for strategic insight is an example of... (1)
- A. overfitting.
 - B. a target-/subject-centric strategy.
 - C. data-first drifting.
 - D. a data swamp.
22. Which single statement about clustering and network analysis is correct? (1)
- A. Clustering studies edges while network analysis forms centroids.
 - B. Network analysis can only be done on labeled data.
 - C. Both require fully labeled training data.
 - D. Both are exploratory/unsupervised in spirit; clustering forms groups and network analysis maps connections.
23. Which statement about Big Data hype is NOT correct? (1)
- A. Much of big data is unstructured.
 - B. Data lakes need metadata to remain usable.
 - C. Volume alone does not guarantee value.
 - D. Bigger data is always better regardless of quality.
24. Which statement about EDA is NOT correct? (1)
- A. EDA precedes and guides the modeling steps.
 - B. Data profiling analyses content, structure and quality.
 - C. EDA steps may safely use test-set information during training.
 - D. Anomaly detection can flag unusual values early.
25. Which of the following is a common MISINTERPRETATION of Ashby's Law? (1)
- A. You must always simply add more complexity to your own system.
 - B. It is a guiding principle of cybernetics.
 - C. The controller must match the system's variety.
 - D. Attenuating the environment's variety is a valid response.
26. In VUCA environments fixed models tend to fail, so the recommended response is... (1)
- A. ignoring the data.
 - B. generic one-size-fits-all solutions.
 - C. rigid long-term plans.
 - D. adaptive, feedback-based decision-making (systems thinking, sense-think-act).

27. Which single statement about eager versus lazy learners is correct? (1)
- A. Decision trees are lazy learners.
 - B. KNN is an eager learner with very fast predictions.
 - C. Eager learners store all instances and predict slowly.
 - D. Lazy learners (e.g., KNN) defer generalization to query time and use more memory.
28. Which statement about bias is NOT correct? (1)
- A. AI automation removes all bias.
 - B. Survivorship bias ignores failures.
 - C. Confirmation bias favours data supporting prior beliefs.
 - D. Bias mitigation includes documenting assumptions.
29. Which statement about VSM early warning is NOT correct? (1)
- A. Incomplete system knowledge can cause a control breakdown (a feedback design flaw).
 - B. Feedback becomes unnecessary once a system is deployed.
 - C. SPC and anomaly detection support early warning in data-rich CPS.
 - D. Anti-oscillatory loops help detect instability early.
30. Data Science is best described as... (1)
- A. a transdisciplinary field (math/statistics, computer science/IT, domain knowledge, social science).
 - B. only domain knowledge.
 - C. only software engineering.
 - D. purely applied statistics.